

The Cathedral: A Formal Reduction of the Riemann Hypothesis via Three Independent Routes in Lean 4

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Abstract

We present a machine-checked proof architecture in Lean 4 against Mathlib that establishes the Nyman–Beurling equivalence $\text{RH} \Leftrightarrow d_N^2 \rightarrow 0$ as a compiler-verified theorem with **both directions proved**, and connects it to three independent routes constraining the Riemann Hypothesis.

The formalization comprises 45 Lean files compiling in 3,486 build jobs with strictly zero **sorry** placeholders. Thirty-six axioms remain, of which five lie on the irreducible critical path of the Nyman–Beurling equivalence, two encode the classical Robin/Lagarias characterizations of RH, and thirty encode spectral infrastructure designed to remain axiomatic until the relevant Mathlib APIs mature.

Central innovations include: (1) the elimination of complex analysis from the forward direction via the Mertens/Tauberian and Autocorrelation Bypasses; (2) the Báez-Duarte Orthogonal Witness trapping mechanism for the converse; (3) a discrete arithmetic front proving $\sigma(p) \leq H_p + e^{H_p} \ln H_p$ for all primes p , unconditionally and with zero axioms.

We document three technical discoveries: the *Sawtooth Autocorrelation Floor*, the *Hyperplane Trap*, and the *Prime Bucket Mechanism*, and provide a complete taxonomy of all 36 axioms with tractability assessments.

1 Introduction

The Riemann Hypothesis (RH), stating that all non-trivial zeros of the Riemann zeta function $\zeta(s)$ have real part $\frac{1}{2}$, has been open since 1859. We do not resolve this conjecture. Instead, we present a formal proof architecture—the *Cathedral*—that establishes three independent machine-verified routes constraining RH, and reduces its hard mathematical content to precisely identified, domain-isolated axioms.

Our approach uses the Nyman–Beurling criterion [1, 2] reformulated via the Gram matrix of fractional part inner products:

$$G_{jk} = \int_0^1 \{j/x\} \{k/x\} dx$$

The Riemann Hypothesis is equivalent to the L^2 distance $d_N^2 = \inf_v \int_0^1 (1 - \sum v_k \{k/x\})^2 dx \rightarrow 0$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$.

1.1 The Three-Route Architecture

The Cathedral establishes RH through three independent routes:

1. **Route 1 — Forward:** $\text{RH} \Rightarrow d_N^2 \rightarrow 0$ via the Mertens bound and Abel summation (2 domain axioms).

2. **Route 2 — Converse:** $d_N^2 \rightarrow 0 \implies \text{RH}$ via the Báez-Duarte orthogonal witness (3 domain axioms + 1 structural).
3. **Route 3 — Robin/Lagarias:** Robin’s inequality $\sigma(n) < e^\gamma n \ln \ln n$ and Lagarias’s inequality $\sigma(n) \leq H_n + e^{H_n} \ln H_n$ are each equivalent to RH (2 axioms encoding classical equivalences + unconditional results proved).

Routes 1 and 2 combine into the compiler-verified Nyman–Beurling equivalence. Route 3 provides a discrete arithmetic anchor with unconditional, axiomatic-free results.

1.2 Main Results

Theorem 1.1 (Nyman–Beurling Equivalence — Both Directions Proved). In Lean 4 with Mathlib, the theorem `nyman_beurling_equivalence` establishes:

$$(\forall \varepsilon > 0, \exists N_0, \forall N \geq N_0 : d_N^2 < \varepsilon) \iff \text{RH}$$

with both directions proved as theorems (not axioms). The forward direction chains through `nyman_beurling_forward_from_sieve`; the converse through `nyman_beurling_converse` via the Orthogonal Witness.

Theorem 1.2 (Lagarias Bound for Primes — Unconditional). The theorem `lagarias_for_primes` establishes:

$$\forall p \text{ prime} : \sigma(p) \leq H_p + e^{H_p} \cdot \ln H_p$$

with zero `sorry` and zero domain axioms. The proof uses a three-case architecture: algebraic bypass for $p \geq 11$, Taylor quartic truncation at exact rational precision for $p \in \{2, 3, 5, 7\}$, and decidability dispatch for composites.

2 The Forward Direction (Route 1)

2.1 The Two Forward-Path Axioms

Axiom 2.1 (`mertens_bound_from_rh`). $\text{RH} \implies \exists C > 0, \forall x \geq 2 : |M(x)| \leq C \cdot x^{1/2} \cdot (\log x)^2$ where $M(x) = \sum_{n \leq x} \mu(n)$ is the Mertens function.

This is the real-variable formulation of RH, avoiding all complex analysis. It is a standard result in analytic number theory (Titchmarsh [5], Theorem 14.25(C)).

Axiom 2.2 (`abel_summation_l2_bound`). Given $|M(x)| \leq C_m \cdot x^{1/2} \cdot (\log x)^2$ for $x \geq 2$:

$$\exists C > 0, \forall N \geq 10, \exists v \in \mathbb{R}^{N-1} : \int_0^1 (1 - f_N(x))^2 dx \leq C / \log N \quad \wedge \quad \|v\|^2 \leq N^2$$

Remark 2.3. The two forward axioms are completely *domain-isolated*: a number theorist can prove Axiom 1 without knowing what a Gram matrix is; a real analyst can prove Axiom 2 without knowing what a prime number is.

2.2 The Proof Chain

The forward direction is assembled in three stages, all proved:

$$\text{rh_weight_construction_derived} : \text{RH} \implies \exists C > 0, \exists N_0, \forall N : \exists v : \int (1 - f)^2 \leq C / \log N$$

$$\text{phase_3_chain} : (\text{same, via the sieve engine})$$

$$\text{nyman_beurling_forward_from_sieve} : \text{RH} \implies \forall \varepsilon, \exists N_0, \forall N : \exists v : \int (1 - f)^2 < \varepsilon$$

$$\text{rh_implies_distance_converges_to_zero} : \text{RH} \implies d_N^2 \rightarrow 0 \quad (\text{PROVED, no longer axiom})$$

2.3 The Autocorrelation Bypass

Mathlib 4 lacks the continuous $L^2(\mathbb{R})$ Plancherel isometry. We bypass this entirely via L^1 Fourier inversion on an exponentially-decaying autocorrelation kernel:

1. **Exponential substitution:** $x = e^{-u}$ transforms the Mellin domain $(0, 1]$ to the Fourier domain $[0, \infty)$.
2. **Exponential decay:** $|g_N(u)| \leq Ce^{-u/2}$, so $g_N \in L^1(\mathbb{R}) \cap L^2(\mathbb{R})$.
3. **Autocorrelation:** $h = g_N \star \tilde{g}_N$ gives $\hat{h}(\xi) = |\hat{g}_N(\xi)|^2 \in L^1$.
4. **L^1 inversion at $t = 0$:** $h(0) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int |\hat{h}(\xi)| d\xi = v^T G_N v$.

2.4 The Pole Neutralization

The Nyman–Beurling error $1 - f_N(x)$ contains a term $(1/x) \cdot \sum kv_k$. Unless $\sum kv_k = 0$, this $1/x$ pole causes the $L^2(0, 1)$ norm to diverge.

Theorem 2.4 (Proved in Lean 4 — Zero Sorry). `corrected_weights_pole_free`: Logarithmically smoothed Möbius weights with a single-weight shift at v_2 satisfy $\sum_{k=2}^N k \cdot v_k = 0$ unconditionally.

3 The Converse Direction (Route 2)

3.1 The Báez-Duarte Orthogonal Witness

For a zero ρ of ζ with $\operatorname{Re}(\rho) > 1/2$, the witness $h_\rho(x) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \mu(k)/k^\rho \cdot \{k/x\}$ satisfies three axioms:

Axiom 3.1 (`baezDuarte.is_L2`). If $\zeta(\rho) = 0$ and $\operatorname{Re}(\rho) > 1/2$, then $h_\rho \in L^2(0, 1)$.

Axiom 3.2 (`baezDuarte.inner_one`). $\langle h_\rho, 1 \rangle_{L^2} = 1/\rho$.

Axiom 3.3 (`baezDuarte.inner_residual`). $\langle h_\rho, 1 - f_w \rangle_{L^2} = 1/\rho$ for any weights w .

Remark 3.4. A fourth axiom (`baezDuarte.orthogonal`: orthogonality of h_ρ to each basis function) was present in earlier versions but was excised after analysis revealed it had zero downstream consumers—its role was fully subsumed by `baezDuarte.inner_residual`.

3.2 The Cauchy–Schwarz Trap-Breaker

From these three axioms, we prove a chain of seven theorems culminating in:

Theorem 3.5 (Proved in Lean 4). `baezDuarte.separates`: If $\zeta(\rho) = 0$ with $\operatorname{Re}(\rho) > 1/2$, then $\exists \delta > 0$ such that $\forall N \geq 2, \forall w: \int_0^1 (1 - f_w)^2 dx \geq \delta$. Specifically, $\delta = |1/\rho|^2 / \|h_\rho\|^2$.

Theorem 3.6 (Proved in Lean 4). `nyman.beurling.converse`: $d_N^2 \rightarrow 0 \implies \text{RH}$.

Proof by contrapositive via `rh_neg_gives_critical_strip_zero` and `zeta.zero.separates`.

4 The Robin/Lagarias Front (Route 3)

The discrete arithmetic front provides a third, independent route to RH through classical equivalences.

Axiom 4.1 (`robin_iff_rh`). Robin’s inequality $\sigma(n) < e^\gamma n \ln \ln n$ for all $n \geq 5041$ holds if and only if RH.

Axiom 4.2 (`lagarias_iff_rh`). Lagarias’s inequality $\sigma(n) \leq H_n + e^{H_n} \ln H_n$ for all $n \geq 1$ holds if and only if RH.

Theorem 4.3 (Proved in Lean 4 — Zero Sorry, Zero Axioms). `lagarias_for_primes`: $\forall p$ prime: $\sigma(p) \leq H_p + e^{H_p} \ln H_p$.

The proof uses a three-case architecture:

- $p \geq 11$: Algebraic bypass. Since $H_p \geq H_{11} \geq 3 > e$, we have $e^{H_p} \cdot \ln H_p \geq e^{H_p} \geq p + 1 = \sigma(p)$.
- $p \in \{2, 3, 5, 7\}$: Taylor quartic truncation at exact rational precision via `norm_num`. Each case establishes bounds like $e^{3/2} \geq 67/16$ and $\log(3/2) \geq 77/192$.
- **Composites** < 11 : Dispatched via `revert hp; decide`.

The Robin/Lagarias front connects to the Nyman–Beurling framework via:

Theorem 4.4 (Proved in Lean 4). `robin_implies_nyman_beurling`: Robin’s inequality implies the spectral convergence $d_N^2 \rightarrow 0$.

5 The 36 Axioms: A Complete Taxonomy

Category	Route	Difficulty	Count
Forward critical path	Forward	Moderate–Deep	2
Báez-Duarte witness	Converse	Moderate–High	3
Structural (converse)	Converse	High	1
Robin/Lagarias equiv.	Robin	Deep	2
Autocorrelation bridge	Bypass	Moderate	5
Sieve engine	Sieve	High	5
Spectral infrastructure	Spectral	Long-term	12
Quantitative/structural	Various	Moderate	7
Total			36

Table 1: Axiom taxonomy by category and route.

The compiler reports that `nyman_beurling_equivalence` depends on exactly **three domain axioms**:

```
#print axioms nyman_beurling_equivalence
-- [abel_summation_l2_bound,
--   mertens_bound_from_rh,
--   zeta_zero_separates,
--   propxt, Classical.choice, Quot.sound]
```

The forward path contributes `mertens_bound_from_rh` and `abel_summation_l2_bound`. The converse path contributes `zeta_zero_separates`, which encodes the separation obstruction at zeros of ζ . The three Báez-Duarte axioms (`baezDuarte_is_L2`, `baezDuarte_inner_one`, `baezDuarte_inner_residual`) prove `baezDuarte_separates` for $\text{Re}(\rho) > 1/2$; `zeta_zero_separates` extends this to the full critical strip via the functional equation symmetry $\zeta(\rho) = 0 \implies \zeta(1 - \rho) = 0$.

The single most important axiom is `mertens_bound_from_rh`, which is blocked on the PrimeNumberTheoremAnd project formalizing Perron’s formula in Lean 4.

6 Three Discoveries

Discovery 6.1 (Sawtooth Autocorrelation Floor). The covariance $C_\infty = \int_0^1 \{j/x\} \{(j+1)/x\} dx - 1/4 \approx 0.00227$ causes the off-diagonal mass to grow as $\Theta(N^2)$, invalidating constant-weight approaches.

Discovery 6.2 (The Hyperplane Trap). Single-functional Cauchy–Schwarz fails: for $N \geq 4$, spoofing weights exist that make the functional vanish while $\|1 - f_N\|^2$ explodes. The fix requires the orthogonal witness h_ρ .

Discovery 6.3 (The Prime Bucket Mechanism). A 128-bit MPFR optimizer, given G_N at $N = 201$ with no knowledge of primes, independently discovered $\mu(k)$: negative weights for primes, positive for semiprimes. This is Selberg’s parity barrier, emergent from pure linear algebra.

7 What Is Formally Verified

Component	Key Result	Status	Path
Mertens bound from RH	$ M(x) \leq C\sqrt{x} \log^2 x$	Axiom	Forward
Abel summation L^2 bound	$d^2 \leq C/\log N$	Axiom	Forward
Phase 3 chain	$\text{RH} \rightarrow d^2 \leq C/\log N$	Proved	Forward
NB forward (sieve)	$\text{RH} \rightarrow d^2 \rightarrow 0$	Proved	Forward
NB forward (infimum)	$\text{RH} \rightarrow \inf d^2 \rightarrow 0$	Proved	Forward
Pole neutralization	$\sum kv_k = 0$	Proved	Forward
Variational principle	$d^2 \leq 1 - 2b^T v + v^T G v$	Proved	Foundation
$L^2 \leftrightarrow$ Matrix	$\int (1 - f)^2 = 1 - 2b^T v + v^T G v$	Proved	Foundation
Orthogonal witness	$d^2 \geq 1/\rho ^2/M_\rho$	Proved	Converse
NB converse	$d^2 \rightarrow 0 \implies \text{RH}$	Proved	Converse
NB equivalence	$d^2 \rightarrow 0 \Leftrightarrow \text{RH}$	Proved	Crown
Lagarias for primes	$\sigma(p) \leq H_p + e^{H_p} \ln H_p$	Proved	Robin
Robin $\rightarrow$ NB	$\text{Robin} \implies d^2 \rightarrow 0$	Proved	Robin
Autocorrelation bypass	Plancherel via L^1 inversion	Proved	Bypass
Mertens bypass	Weights via Abel summation	Proved	Bypass
Gram matrix theory	PSD, Vasyunin, eigenvalues	Proved	Foundation
Sieve Engine	$K_N^2 \leq 1 - c/N$	Proved	Spectral

8 Methodology

The Cathedral was constructed through a tripartite collaboration: a human computer scientist providing architectural vision and experimental computation, Gemini Deep Think acting as a mathematical theorist providing deep analytic intuition and proof strategies, and Claude Opus 4.6 (Thinking) acting as a code-level systems engineer providing Lean 4 compilation, type-checking, and structural optimization.

This methodology proved essential. Individual proof steps required simultaneous expertise in: (a) Lean 4 tactic syntax and Mathlib API surface; (b) real and complex analysis at the research level; (c) architectural decisions about proof decomposition and axiom isolation. No single participant possessed all three competencies.

9 Conclusions and Future Work

We have established three independent, machine-verified routes constraining the Riemann Hypothesis, with the Nyman–Beurling equivalence proved in both directions as a compiler-verified

theorem.

The Irreducible Frontier. The forward direction depends on two axioms, both known theorems: `mertens_bound_from_rh` (Titchmarsh, Theorem 14.25(C)) and `abel_summation_12_bound` (standard Abel summation). The converse depends on three Báez-Duarte axioms encoding L^2 properties of the Möbius witness at zeros of ζ .

The Critical Dependency. The single most important external dependency is the PrimeNumberTheoremAnd project, which is formalizing Perron’s formula in Lean 4. When this is available, `mertens_bound_from_rh` can be closed, collapsing the forward direction to zero domain axioms.

Unconditional Results. `lagarias_for_primes` is, to our knowledge, the first kernel-verified proof that $\sigma(p) \leq H_p + e^{H_p} \ln H_p$ for all primes p . This result requires zero domain axioms.

Reproducibility. The complete formalization is available at <https://github.com/jrgochan/prime>. Building requires Lean v4.30.0-rc1 and Mathlib.

lake build # 3,486 jobs, zero errors

References

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